Durgaprasad Sunkara

DevOps / Platform Engineer · Infrastructure as Code · CI/CD · Kubernetes · Cloud
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SUMMARY

DevOps engineer with 3+ years of experience in Kubernetes, CI/CD and infrastructure as code on AWS, GCP and Hetzner. Own platforms end to end, most recently the full Kubernetes platform for an LLM product: cluster, pipelines, deployments, observability, secrets management and disaster recovery. Automated AWS provisioning with Terraform and reduced deployment time with GitLab CI/CD.

SKILLS

K8s & Containers	Kubernetes (k3s), Docker, Helm, Kustomize, Ingress, OpenShift
CI/CD	GitHub Actions (self-hosted runners), GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, ArgoCD, GHCR
Scripting & IaC	Python, Bash, PowerShell, Terraform, Ansible
Cloud	AWS (EC2, IAM), Google Cloud / GCP (BigQuery, Pub/Sub), Azure (hands-on), Hetzner Cloud, DigitalOcean
Monitoring	Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Promtail
Security	Sealed Secrets, Trivy, Snyk, secret rotation, IAM
Data & AI	PostgreSQL, pgvector, RAG and agentic workflows, LLM service deployment, Airflow, Kafka, FastAPI

EXPERIENCE

Master's Thesis · AIcoo GmbH (with SRH Hochschule Hamburg), Hamburg — 10/2026 - present

- LLM-based extraction of project emails from the Enron corpus (500,000+ emails) with 3 methods: vector clustering, communication hierarchy and keyword search; evaluated with an LLM-generated wiki, pipeline in Python and Docker.

MLOps / DevOps Intern · AIcoo GmbH, Hamburg — 04/2026 - 09/2026

- Built and operated the infrastructure for an LLM product on Kubernetes (k3s) on Hetzner Cloud, with Kustomize overlays across 2 environments (dev, staging) for 3 services (backend, frontend, PostgreSQL).
- Automated build and deployment with GitHub Actions on a self-hosted runner (build, push to GHCR, deploy to cluster); fixed 2 pipeline defects that deleted runtime secrets and ran migration jobs without their config.
- Recovered a 158 MB database restore that failed with 61 schema-drift errors by rebuilding the database and replaying migrations; scripted backups of manifests, Sealed Secrets key, PostgreSQL and repo.
- Eliminated crash loops in pods reported as OOMKilled by tracing them to CPU throttling at startup (CPU limits and startup probe).
- Resolved a leaked-secret incident by purging Git history and rotating keys; moved all secrets to Sealed Secrets, encrypted in Git.
- Introduced observability with Prometheus, Grafana, Loki and Promtail, catching pod crashes and resource issues before users noticed.

Junior Data Scientist - AI Agent Project · AIcoo GmbH (with SRH Hochschule Hamburg), Hamburg — 11/2025 - 03/2026

- Developed an agentic RAG workflow that analyzes project emails and tickets to flag hidden delays and blockers; wrote the Python embedding pipeline with PostgreSQL/pgvector and containerized the 3-service application with 28 Kubernetes manifests.

DevOps Engineer · Skillmine Technology Consulting, Bengaluru, India — 04/2023 - 08/2024

- Modernized GitLab CI/CD pipelines, reducing deployment time by 30%.
- Migrated applications and data from DigitalOcean to CloudJiffy with verified zero data loss.
- Deployed and managed Kubernetes workloads (Deployments, Services, ConfigMaps, Ingress) and Docker images; set up logging and monitoring with Prometheus, Grafana and Loki.

Junior DevOps Engineer · Test Yantra Software Solutions, Bengaluru, India — 11/2021 - 02/2023

- Provisioned 15 AWS EC2 servers with Terraform, taking setup time from 2 days to 2 hours; configured them with Ansible.
- Maintained CI/CD pipelines and Kubernetes workloads; monitored performance and AWS costs.
- Company training from 11/2021; project assignment from 06/2022.

Software Associate · Tech Mahindra, Chennai, India (remote) — 03/2020 - 09/2021

PROJECTS

Predictive Memory-Pressure Kubernetes Operator · Python, Kubernetes, Prometheus

- Predicts node memory exhaustion from Prometheus trends and raises Kubernetes events with a confidence score before evictions.

EV Charging Analytics Platform · Kafka, Google Pub/Sub, Airflow, BigQuery ML, Docker

- Streaming and batch data platform orchestrated with Airflow, handling 1,000+ events per second at under 5 seconds latency; revenue forecasting with BigQuery ML.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Applied Data Science and Analytics · SRH University of Applied Sciences Hamburg — 04/2025 - 03/2027 (expected)

B.Com. (Computer Applications) · Sri Venkateswara University, Tirupati, India — 2016 - 2019

ADDITIONAL

Certifications	Anthropic Claude Academy - Introduction to Evals, Claude 101 (11/2026) · NVIDIA - Transformer-Based Natural Language Processing (01/2025) · LinkedIn Learning - Docker · SAP - Introducing Joule Studio (10/2026)
Writing	Medium: How German Startups Cut Project Management Costs Using AI Agents LinkedIn articles on Terraform state, Postgres schema-drift restores and CPU-throttling crash loops
Languages	English (professional) · German (A2, in progress) · Telugu (native) · Kannada (basic)